

Pierluigi Baroncelli

Principal / Lead Product Designer

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PROFILE

Principal/Lead Product Designer with 15+ years shaping fintech, edtech, and web products. Progressed from contractor to Head of Product Design at Times Higher Education, where I led the flagship platform redesign, created THE's first design system, and launched new data products. Previous highlights include the GlintPay app redesign, Tide desktop onboarding, and NatWest CurrencyPay activation flow. I actively integrate AI tooling into my design workflow — including vibe coding with Claude and building with component systems like shadcn/ui.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and scaled THE's first design system — reduced design-to-dev delivery time ~40%, ensured WCAG compliance, adopted across platforms.
- Led phased platform redesign at THE — improved usability and engagement for thousands of global university customers.
- Directed DataPoints redesign — enabled new revenue stream with improved data clarity and partner adoption.
- Redesigned GlintPay app (iOS/Android) — enhanced clarity and engagement, driving stronger customer retention.

CORE SKILLS

Strategy & UX	Discovery, information architecture, research, prototyping
Design Systems	Tokens, scalability, WCAG compliance, developer handoff
Leadership	Stakeholder alignment, agile delivery, team mentoring
Specialisms	Fintech, edtech, publishing platforms, AI/LLM design
Tools	Figma, Miro, Jira, Confluence, Hotjar, Maze, Claude

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer	1st Formations · Contract	Jan – Apr 2026
• Updated and extended UI components to align with brand standards. • Adapted shadcn/ui as the foundation for their design system — improved consistency and developer handoff. • Explored AI-assisted design workflows using Claude to accelerate delivery.		

Head of Product Design	Times Higher Education	Nov 2022 – May 2025
• Promoted from Principal Designer to lead the design function across SaaS and web platforms. • Redesigned THE's flagship platform — phased rollout improving usability and engagement for global university customers. • Created and scaled THE Design System — reduced delivery ~40%, improved consistency, ensured accessibility compliance. • Directed DataPoints redesign — supported launch of new data product, unlocking new revenue opportunities. • Mentored design team and aligned executives, embedding research and analytics into strategic decisions.		

Principal Product Designer	Times Higher Education	Feb 2021 – Oct 2022
• Led major platform initiatives, shaping updates and new feature rollouts. • Improved THE DataPoints — simplified data exploration and increased partner adoption. • Introduced cross-team design reviews — scaled collaboration and reduced duplication.		

Senior Product Designer	Times Higher Education · Contract	Aug 2020 – Jan 2021
• Delivered core product improvements and early features that improved usability. • Laid the groundwork for THE Design System, creating reusable patterns that later scaled.		

Senior Product Designer	NatWest CurrencyPay · Contract	2020
• Designed onboarding process — improved activation and compliance. • Collaborated with product and engineering to deliver customer-focused features.		

Senior Product Designer	Tide · Contract	2020
• Supported design of the desktop banking app in the context of open banking. • Designed in-app notification system.		

Senior Product Designer	GlintPay · Contract	2018 – 2019
• Redesigned iOS and Android apps end-to-end for a fintech product using open banking. • Created a more cohesive and usable cross-platform experience.		

Product Design Lead	Hive · Contract	2016 – 2018
• Redesigned Hive's e-commerce website — improved product discovery, checkout, and payment flows.		

Senior Product Designer	Schibsted Media Group · Contract	2016
• White-label marketplace platform — focused on search and filtering for product discovery.		

Senior Product Designer	OVO Energy · Contract	2016
• Helped redesign iOS and Android apps, delivering wireframes and mockups.		

Senior Product Designer	HSBC · Contract	2015
• Responsive UI design for the HSBC banking website via HeathWallace.		

EARLIER ROLES

Kabbee — Senior Product Designer (2015) · Dennis Publishing — Lead Mobile Designer (2014) · Fanatix — Mobile Designer (2013) · Moneywise — Product Designer (2013) · MailOnline — Product Designer (2011–2012)

